Heuristic Evaluation

Employee Management System

SEP2 Sprint 7 - Spring 2026

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1. Introduction

This is a heuristic evaluation of our Employee Management System. The four of us, Jesper, Mehdi, Amir and Osama, went through the application separately and noted down anything that looked like a usability problem, using Nielsen's 10 heuristics as a checklist. Each of us also gave the issues a severity rating from 0 to 4. The findings are then collected here.

2. Method

2.1 The 10 heuristics we used

- H1-1: Simple & natural dialog
- H1-2: Speak the users' language
- H1-3: Minimize users' memory load
- H1-4: Consistency
- H1-5: Feedback
- H1-6: Clearly marked exits
- H1-7: Shortcuts
- H1-8: Precise & constructive error messages
- H1-9: Prevent errors
- H1-10: Help and documentation

2.2 Severity scale

Rating	Meaning
0	Not really a problem
1	Cosmetic - fix if there's time
2	Minor - should be fixed eventually
3	Major - needs to be fixed
4	Critical - has to be fixed before release

3. Combined findings

The table below collects all the issues from the four of us, grouped so each row is one underlying problem. A dash (–) means that evaluator didn't flag this one. The Avg column is the average of the ratings that were given. Anything averaging 3 or higher is worth prioritising.

H#	Issue	J	M	A	O	Avg
H1-1	Sidebar emoji icons inconsistent / look like decoration	-	1	-	-	1.0
H1-1	Department Overview table hard to read (transparent)	2	-	-	-	2.0
H1-1	Icons render as boxes in View cards / popups	2	-	-	-	2.0
H1-1	Leave Management page has unnecessary explanatory text	-	0	-	-	0.0
H1-1	Create Account form not responsive — fields disappear	-	-	3	-	3.0
H1-1	"All Department" filter cut off on Salary page	-	-	-	2	2.0
H1-1	Search field placement in department drill-down	2	-	-	-	2.0
H1-2	No language selector on login page	1	-	-	-	1.0
H1-2	Action buttons truncated to 2 characters	-	1	-	2	1.5
H1-2	"Del" label is unclear — should say "Delete"	-	-	2	-	2.0
H1-3	Search field doesn't say what it searches	2	-	-	-	2.0
H1-3	Must navigate elsewhere to create prerequisite records	-	2	-	2	2.0
H1-3	Form labels shrink to "..." in small windows	-	-	3	-	3.0
H1-4	Inconsistent translation across pages	-	-	3	-	3.0
H1-4	Inconsistent emoji/icon use in sidebar	-	1	-	-	1.0
H1-4	Row click highlight with no clear purpose	1	-	-	-	1.0
H1-4	Quick Action buttons missing hover states	-	-	-	1	1.0
H1-5	No success/error message after form submission	-	2	4	-	3.0
H1-5	Non-sequential employee IDs after deletion	1	-	-	-	1.0
H1-5	Department filter broken in Leave Management	3	-	-	-	3.0
H1-5	"Generate Report" button on Dashboard does nothing	-	-	-	3	3.0
H1-6	No logout confirmation	1	-	2	-	1.5
H1-6	Cannot cancel operation in progress	-	2	-	2	2.0
H1-7	No keyboard shortcuts	2	2	-	2	2.0
H1-7	Quick Actions only on Dashboard, not other pages	-	-	1	-	1.0

H#	Issue	J	M	A	O	Avg
H1-8	No warning when start date is in the past	2	-	-	-	**2.0**
H1-8	No clear error on failed actions	-	2	-	2	**2.0**
H1-8	No password validation errors during account creation	-	-	4	-	**4.0**
H1-9	Save with all required fields empty	4	-	-	-	**4.0**
H1-9	Duplicate leave entries with same parameters	3	-	-	-	**3.0**
H1-9	"All Contracts" reset empties employee list	3	-	-	-	**3.0**
H1-9	No real-time field validation	-	2	-	-	**2.0**
H1-9	Missing "Forgot password" link	2	-	-	-	**2.0**
H1-9	Salary page doesn't accept Persian numbers	-	-	3	-	**3.0**
H1-9	Can submit leave for an employee already on leave	-	-	-	3	**3.0**
H1-10	No help menu, tooltips, or user guide	-	3	2	-	**2.5**
H1-10	Unlabelled department filter / navigation button	3	-	-	-	**3.0**
H1-10	Department filter dropdown blank, no placeholder	-	-	-	1	**1.0**

Column key: J = Jesper, M = Mehdi, A = Amir, O = Osama.

4. Findings - Jesper

ID	H#	Issue	Sev	Suggested fix
J1	H1-1	Dashboard: The Department Overview table has a transparent background and very light text, hard to read.	2	Give the table a solid background and darker text.
J2	H1-1	Employees / Leave: In the View cards and popups, some icons show up as empty boxes instead of the actual icons.	2	Bundle the icon font with the app instead of loading it from a CDN.
J3	H1-1	Departments: In the drill-down view, "Search employees" is in the top-right corner, far from the list. Easy to miss.	2	Move the search field directly above the employee list.
J4	H1-2	Login: No language switcher on the login page. The rest of the app supports translation but the login screen is English only.	1	Add the same language dropdown that the rest of the app uses.
J5	H1-3	Employees: The search field doesn't say which field it actually searches. The user has to guess whether to type a name, ID or job title.	2	Change the placeholder text to "Search by name, ID or job title".
J6	H1-4	Employees / Departments: Clicking a row makes it look highlighted (white transparent), but nothing actually happens.	1	Either remove the highlight or make the row click do something useful like opening the View dialog.
J7	H1-5	Employees: After deleting an employee, the IDs are not re-sorted. For example removing employee 2 leaves 1 and 3 with a visible gap.	1	Sort by ID on render, or add a separate row number column.
J8	H1-5	Leave: The Department filter does nothing. Picking "Sales" still shows everyone.	3	Wire up the filter on the Leave History query.
J9	H1-6	The logout button ends the session immediately with no confirmation. If the user has unsaved changes in a form, those are lost.	1	Show a confirmation dialog ("Are you sure you want to log out?") before ending the session.
J10	H1-7	There are no keyboard shortcuts for common actions like focusing search, adding a new employee, or saving a form.	2	Add shortcuts like Ctrl+F for search and Ctrl+N for new record, and show them as tooltips.
J11	H1-8	Employees: You can change a start date to a date in the past with no warning.	2	Show a warning if the date is in the past and ask for confirmation.
J12	H1-9	Login: No "Forgot password" option. If a user forgets their password, there's no way to reset it.	2	Add a "Forgot password" link under the Sign In button.
J13	H1-9	Employees: You can save an employee with all the fields empty. The empty record shows up in the database.	4	Disable Save until required fields are filled, and highlight any missing fields.

ID	H#	Issue	Sev	Suggested fix
J14	H1-9	Employees: Filtering by a contract type then switching back to "All Contracts" empties the table. Other filters reset fine.	3	Make "All Contracts" re-query all employees.
J15	H1-9	Leave: You can add the exact same leave entry for the same employee twice. Nothing checks for duplicates.	3	Check for matching employee + dates + type before saving.
J16	H1-10	Departments: Unlabelled dropdown in the toolbar with no tooltip. Opens a drill-down view where Edit / Delete / View buttons don't work.	3	Label the control and fix the broken buttons in the drill-down view.

5. Findings - Mehdi

ID	H#	Issue	Sev	Suggested fix
M1	H1-1	Leave Management page contains unnecessary explanatory text.	0	Remove the text.
M2	H1-2	"View", "Edit", "Delete" buttons are cut to two characters in the tables.	1	Make sure the full button labels fit.
M3	H1-3	To create a leave or employee, the user has to navigate elsewhere first to make the prerequisite record.	2	Add visible "Create" buttons on the relevant pages.
M4	H1-4	The sidebar shows emojis next to some page titles but not others.	1	Use icons consistently across all sidebar items.
M5	H1-5	No success or error message after submitting forms.	2	Show a confirmation message after submit / edit / delete.
M6	H1-6	Once an action is running, there's no way to cancel it.	2	Add a cancel button while operations are in progress.
M7	H1-7	No keyboard shortcuts.	2	Add shortcuts for common actions.
M8	H1-8	When something fails, the system doesn't explain what went wrong.	2	Show specific error messages.
M9	H1-9	No real-time validation while filling out forms.	2	Validate fields as the user types.
M10	H1-10	No help, FAQ, or guidance anywhere in the system.	3	Add a help / FAQ section.

6. Findings — Amir

ID	H#	Issue	Sev	Suggested fix
A1	H1-1	Create Account form is not responsive — when the window is resized, half the form disappears.	3	Use a flex/grid layout so all fields stay visible at any window size.
A2	H1-2	The Delete button is labelled "Del" everywhere, which is unclear.	2	Use the full word "Delete" (or its translation).
A3	H1-3	Form labels shrink to "..." when the window is small, so the user has to remember what each field was.	3	Wrap the text or show a tooltip — never truncate important labels.
A4	H1-4	Some pages translate properly (Dashboard) but others don't (Next/Previous, Department Overview, Recent Activities, Salary actions).	3	Make sure every UI string is loaded from the same translation file — no hardcoded English.
A5	H1-5	After creating an account, there's no success message and no redirect to the login page.	4	Show a success toast and redirect automatically.
A6	H1-6	Logout happens immediately with no confirmation, so a misclick can lose unsaved work.	2	Add a confirmation dialog ("Are you sure you want to log out?").
A7	H1-7	The Quick Actions panel only exists on the Dashboard, not on other pages.	1	Add quick shortcuts on all major pages.
A8	H1-8	Password validation errors don't appear during account creation. If something is wrong the form just doesn't submit, with no explanation.	4	Show inline errors per field, highlight problem fields in red, and explain the requirements (e.g. password rules).
A9	H1-9	The Salary page doesn't accept Persian numbers.	3	Accept Persian/Arabic numerals or convert them automatically.
A10	H1-10	No tooltips, no help icons, no guidance for new users.	2	Add tooltips and a "?" info popup on the trickier fields.

7. Findings — Osama

ID	H#	Issue	Sev	Suggested fix
O1	H1-1	"All Department" filter on the Salary page is partially cut off / hidden in LTR mode.	2	Make the filter container responsive across language modes.
O2	H1-2	"Edit" and "View" buttons get truncated in Persian/Arabic, showing only a few characters.	2	Use responsive button widths so the full label always fits.
O3	H1-3	To create a leave request or employee, the user has to navigate away first to create the prerequisite record.	2	Add visible "Create" buttons on the relevant pages.
O4	H1-4	Quick Action buttons don't have hover states; "Add New Employee" stays blue by default.	1	Add consistent hover effects for all action buttons.
O5	H1-5	"Generate Report" button on the Dashboard does nothing when clicked — no feedback at all.	3	Wire up a click handler and show a loading / success toast.
O6	H1-6	Once an action is running, there's no way to cancel it.	2	Add a cancel option during processing.
O7	H1-7	No shortcuts for navigation.	2	Add keyboard shortcuts.
O8	H1-8	When a form action fails, the system doesn't say what went wrong.	2	Show specific error messages.
O9	H1-9	The Employee dropdown lets you submit a leave for someone who is already on leave (IDs 1–10), so you can double-book.	3	Filter the dropdown to exclude employees who already have an active leave for the chosen dates.
O10	H1-10	Department filter dropdown on the Department page is blank — no placeholder text.	1	Add placeholder text like "Select Department...".

8. What to fix first

Pulling out the issues that landed at severity 3 or 4 with at least one of us, since those are the ones that most affect the user.

Priority	Issue	Fix
Critical	Save employee with all required fields empty (J)	Disable Save until required fields are filled.
Critical	No success message + no redirect after creating an account (A)	Show toast and redirect to login.
Critical	No password validation errors during account creation (A)	Inline errors + clear password rules.
Major	Create Account form breaks on resize (A)	Use a responsive layout.
Major	Form labels shrink to "..." in small windows (A)	Wrap text or use tooltips.
Major	Inconsistent translation across pages (A)	Move all UI strings into the translation file.
Major	"All Contracts" reset empties employee list (J)	Fix the reset path.
Major	Department filter broken in Leave Management (J)	Wire up the filter.
Major	Duplicate leave entries allowed (J)	Check for duplicates before saving.
Major	Unlabelled control + broken Edit/Delete/View in dept drill-down (J)	Label it and fix the buttons.
Major	No help / tooltips / user guide (M)	Add tooltips and a help section.
Major	"Generate Report" button does nothing (O)	Wire up the click and show feedback.
Major	Salary page doesn't accept Persian numbers (A)	Normalize numerical input.
Major	Can submit leave for someone already on leave (O)	Filter the dropdown by active leaves.

9. Wrap-up

Between the four of us we found a wide range of issues, with a fair amount of overlap on things like missing feedback, missing keyboard shortcuts and missing help, those are clearly the weakest spots in the current build. The most urgent things are the form validation gaps (anyone can create empty records, account creation gives no feedback) and the broken filters/buttons that make whole pages unreliable. The cosmetic issues (truncated buttons, missing hovers, transparent tables) can wait but should still get fixed before we present the system.